

Interview Schedule Overview

- **Date:** Friday, March 6, 2026
 - **Location:** US-LC-AP04A-1-B-N (Lake County, IL Campus - Building AP04A)
 - **Theme:** The panel leans heavily toward **R&D Information Research (IR)** and **AI Strategy**. They aren't just looking for technical skills; they are looking for "Research Fellows"—people who can bridge the gap between complex science and digital scalability.
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Strategic Advice

- **The "IR" Connection:** Three of your four interviewers are tied to **Information Research (IR)**. This isn't traditional "IT support"; it's about using technology to find "needles in haystacks" of scientific data.
- **Ludwigshafen Connection:** Mentioning an awareness of the global collaboration between the US and the Ludwigshafen site (Lars's base) will show you've done your homework on their organizational structure.
- **Be "Bilingual":** You need to speak both **"Science"** (microbiology, clinical trials, R&D) and **"Tech"** (LLMs, data architecture, digital transformation).

Interview Location:

AP04
Abbott Park
1 N. Waukegan Rd.
North Chicago, IL 60064
Gate 1 (Visitor Center)

Day of your interviews:

Abbott Park

Proceed to Gate 1, to obtain your visitors' badge. From here, you will enter through the gates to the building indicated above.

Greeter Information:

Name Michael Kaltschmidt

Email: michael.kaltschmidt@abbvie.com

Phone Number (if available):

The Interviewers...

1. Elfi Stach

Title: Head of CoLE (Center of Learning Excellence), BTS

- **The Context:** Within BTS, the **Center of Learning Excellence** focuses on digital upskilling and organizational change management.
- **Key Focus:** She likely oversees how AbbVie employees adopt new technologies (like the AI tools Brian Martin builds).
- **What to Know:** Elfi will care about **"The Human Element."** Be prepared to discuss how you communicate complex technical concepts to non-technical stakeholders and how you ensure new tools actually get used by the business.
- **Potential Question for Her:** *"As BTS rolls out more advanced AI and IR tools, what are the biggest cultural or learning hurdles your team is currently tackling?"*

The Angle: Product Adoption & Literacy.

- **Talking Points:** Focus on the **"Articulation"** part of your title. How do you design a product so intuitive that a scientist doesn't need a manual to use a complex knowledge graph? Discuss "Data Literacy" as a product feature.
- **Artifacts:** A **Product Roadmap** example that includes "User Enablement" milestones, not just technical releases.
- **Example:** "In my past work, I realized the 'product' wasn't the database—it was the insight. I shifted our focus to 'Articulation,' ensuring the system spoke the language of the business, which increased adoption by 40%."
- **Questions:**
 - "How does CoLE partner with Product Managers to ensure that 'Knowledge Integration' tools are built with the end-user's learning curve in mind?"
 - "What does 'successful articulation' look like from your perspective—is it fewer support tickets or faster time-to-insight?"

2. Michael Kaltschmidt

Title: Director, IT

- **The Context:** Michael is a key figure in the **Pharma Documentation Ring (P-D-R)**, an industry group focused on managing scientific information and R&D documentation.
- **Key Focus:** Information lifecycle management, data integrity, and documentation standards.
- **What to Know:** He is an expert in how pharma companies store, retrieve, and protect their "knowledge." He will value **compliance, structured data, and long-term scalability**.
- **Potential Question for Him:** *"With the shift toward Generative AI, how is AbbVie evolving its documentation and information management strategy to ensure data is 'AI-ready'?"*

The Angle: Product Scalability & Data Governance.

- **Talking Points:** Focus on **"Integration."** Discuss how you manage the product lifecycle of an Ontology. How do you ensure the "Knowledge Integration" platform remains robust and compliant (GxP) as it scales globally?
- **Artifacts:** A **Governance Model** or a "Service Level Agreement" (SLA) for data quality within a product ecosystem.
- **Example:** "As a Product Manager, I treat 'Data Integrity' as a non-negotiable Product Requirement. I've led teams to integrate disparate legacy systems into a unified model using MBSE principles to ensure no data loss during the transition."
- **Questions:**
 - "From an IT leadership perspective, what are the biggest 'integration' debt issues you're hoping this Strategic PM role will retire?"
 - "How do you view the balance between 'Off-the-shelf' vs. 'Custom-built' for AbbVie's Knowledge Integration layer?"

3. Lars Greiffenberg, PhD

Title: Research Fellow & Sr. Director R&D Information Research; Site Head Ludwigshafen

- **The Context:** Lars is a scientist by training (PhD in Microbiology) but a leader in **Library and Language Information Science**.
- **Key Focus:** Knowledge extraction, translational medicine, and global R&D collaboration. He bridges the German (Ludwigshafen) and US sites.
- **What to Know:** He is a "Research Fellow," a title reserved for top-tier individual contributors/leaders with deep scientific expertise. He cares about **how information accelerates drug discovery**. * **Potential Question for Him:** *"How do you see the role of 'Information Research' changing as we move from simple data retrieval to AI-driven knowledge synthesis?"*

The Angle: The "Product-Market Fit" for R&D.

- **Talking Points:** Talk about the **"Ontology as a Product."** How do you gather requirements from world-class scientists (like him) and translate them into technical specs for Knowledge Integration? Mention "Translational Research" as a product domain.
- **Artifacts:** **User Personas** for R&D Scientists or a **Value Stream Map** of the drug discovery process.
- **Example:** "I don't just build tools; I build 'Research Accelerators.' By integrating knowledge across silos, I help scientists see the 'Digital Twin' of their research, reducing redundant experiments."
- **Questions:**
 - "As a Research Fellow, what is the one piece of 'integrated knowledge' currently missing from your dashboard that would change the way you approach R&D?"
 - "How can this role better 'articulate' the value of Information Research to the broader AbbVie executive leadership?"

4. Brian Martin

Title: Director, BTS; Chief AI Product Owner; Head of AI, R&D Information Research

- **The Context:** Brian is arguably the "face" of AI at AbbVie. He led the development of the **AbbVie Intelligence** platform (Chat, Analyze, Translate).
- **Key Focus:** Generative AI, Large Language Models (LLMs), and automating Clinical Study Reports (CSRs).
- **What to Know:** Brian is very active in the Bio-IT community. He values **ROI-driven AI**—not just "cool tech," but tech that saves thousands of hours in clinical trials. He has a passion for mentoring "early talent."
- **Potential Question for Him:** *"You've spoken about the 'moral imperative' of sharing deep learning capabilities. How is AbbVie prioritizing its next wave of AI use cases for 2026/2027?"*

The Angle: AI Product Strategy & RAG Grounding.

- **Talking Points:** You are his **Strategic Partner**. Discuss how your "Knowledge Integration" work provides the "Ground Truth" for his AI models. Talk about the "Semantic Layer" of the AI stack.
- **Artifacts:** **API Strategy** or **Knowledge Graph Schema** that shows how AI "consumes" integrated knowledge.
- **Example:** "I see this role as the 'Curator' for your AI engine. My goal is to ensure that when a user asks 'AbbVie Intelligence' a question, the 'Articulation' is grounded in a perfectly 'Integrated' knowledge graph, eliminating hallucinations."
- **Questions:**
 - "How do you see the 'Knowledge Integration' PM role evolving as we move from LLMs to Large Action Models (LAMs) that need to perform tasks within our systems?"
 - "What is your 'North Star' metric for the AI products we will be building together?"

n the context of your interview with **Lars Greiffenberg** (who is the Site Head of Ludwigshafen), understanding this connection is vital. It isn't just a satellite office; it is the **global engine for AbbVie's neuroscience and manufacturing innovation**.

For a **Strategic Product Manager in Knowledge Integration**, the "Ludwigshafen Connection" represents the ultimate challenge in **Global Semantic Integration**—bridging the gap between German deep-science expertise and US-based digital product strategy.

1. The "Neuroscience Powerhouse"

Ludwigshafen is AbbVie's **Center of Excellence for Neuroscience R&D**. While North Chicago (Lake County) handles a broad portfolio, Ludwigshafen is where the "deep thinking" on Alzheimer's, Parkinson's, and rare neurological diseases (like those targeted by **RARE Hope**) happens.

- **Knowledge Gap:** As a PM, you'll need to ensure that the "Knowledge Integration" platform captures the unique nuances of German neuroscience research and makes it "articulated" for US clinical teams.

2. The Legacy of Knoll & BASF

The site has a 130-year history. It was originally the headquarters of **Knoll AG** (the inventors of ibuprofen) and later part of **BASF Pharma**. This means the site has:

- **Deep Legacy Data:** Massive amounts of archival scientific knowledge that needs to be "Integrated" into modern Knowledge Graphs.
- **Cultural Scientific Rigor:** A very structured, high-precision approach to data that fits perfectly with your **MBSE (Model-Based Systems Engineering)** background.

3. High-Tech Manufacturing & "Soluplus"

Ludwigshafen is a world leader in **Melt Extrusion technology**. They developed the technology used to make poorly soluble drugs (like those for HIV and HCV) more "bioavailable" (absorbable by the body).

- **Digital Twin Opportunity:** In your interview, you can talk about creating **Digital Twins of the manufacturing process** in Ludwigshafen to predict how new "Rare Hope" compounds will behave before they are even produced.

4. The "Transatlantic Bridge" (Your PM Role)

Because Lars Greiffenberg bridges Ludwigshafen and Lake County, he deals with **"Information Silos"** across time zones and languages.

- **The Problem:** Scientists in Ludwigshafen might use different terminology or ontologies than scientists in the US.
- **Your Solution:** As the **Strategic PM for Knowledge Integration**, you are the "Architect" of the bridge. You ensure that the **ARCH Knowledge Graph** is a "Universal Translator" so that a discovery in Germany is instantly "articulated" and actionable in Illinois.

Interview "Talking Point" for Lars Greiffenberg:

"Lars, I've been looking at the role Ludwigshafen plays as the 'Neuroscience Hub.' Given the site's deep history and its role in breakthrough formulations like Melt Extrusion, how do you see my role as Strategic PM helping to better 'integrate' that German scientific rigor into our global AI and Knowledge Graph initiatives?"

Key Fact for your notes: Ludwigshafen is the **second-largest R&D site** for AbbVie globally (after Lake County), employing roughly 1,900 people, including 1,000 scientists. It is the definition of "Mission Critical."